

# YI-CHUNG CHEN

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## EDUCATION

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**Purdue University**, West Lafayette, Indiana, United States

*Sep 2024 - present*

*Ph.D. in Electrical and Computer Engineering*

- Advisors: Prof. Jing Gao and Prof. David Inouye
- GPA: 4.0 / 4.0

**National Taiwan University (NTU)**, Taipei, Taiwan

*Sep 2021 - June 2023*

*M.S. in Communication Engineering, (Data Science Group)*

- Advisor: Prof. Ming-Syan Chen
- GPA: 4.25 / 4.3

**National Yang Ming Chiao Tung University (NYCU)**, Hsinchu, Taiwan

*Sep 2017 - June 2021*

*B.S. in Electronics Engineering*

- Advisors: Prof. Wen-Huang Cheng and Prof. Hong-Han Shuai
- GPA: 3.91 / 4.3

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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My primary research interest lies at the intersection of **trustworthy machine learning** and **physical AI**, with a focus on **robustness**, **interpretability**, and **uncertainty**. I am currently interested in **uncertainty-aware planning with world models**. Previously, I have explored **generative classification**, **multi-agent behavior prediction**, **diffusion model quantization**, and **federated learning**.

## PUBLICATIONS

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### Conference Papers

**Chen, Yi-Chung**, Kim, Mingyu, Bai, Ruqi, Hare, James Z., Gao, Jing, & Inouye, David I. (2026). StarCraft Motion: A Dataset for Agent Simulation in Adversarial and Partially Observable Scenarios. Neural Information Processing Systems, ED Track. (NeurIPS 2026)

**Chen, Yi-Chung**, Inouye, David I., & Gao, Jing (2026). Your VAR Model is Secretly an Efficient and Explainable Generative Classifier. International Conference on Learning Representations. (ICLR 2026)

**Chen, Yi-Chung**, Huang, Zhi-Kai, & Chen, Jing-Ren (2024). StepbaQ: Stepping backward as Correction for Quantized Diffusion Models. Neural Information Processing Systems. (NeurIPS 2024)

**Chen, Yi-Chung**, Chen, Hsi-Wen, Wang, Shun-Gui, & Chen, Ming-Syan (2023). SPACE: Single-round Participant Amalgamation for Contribution Evaluation in Federated Learning. Neural Information Processing Systems. (NeurIPS 2023)

Chen, Chieh-Yun\*, **Chen, Yi-Chung\***, Shuai, Hong-Han, & Cheng, Wen-Huang (2023). Size Does Matter: Size-aware Virtual Try-on via Clothing-oriented Transformation Try-on Network. IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision. (ICCV 2023)

Chang, Chi-Rung, Lung, Kuan-Yu, **Chen, Yi-Chung**, Huang, Zhi-Kai, Shuai, Hong-Han, & Cheng, Wen-Huang (2019). Stop Hiding Behind Windshield: A Windshield Image Enhancer Based on a Two-way Generative Adversarial Network. Proceedings of the ACM Multimedia Asia. (MM Asia 2019)

### Journal Articles

**Chen, Yi-Chung**, Huang, Zhi-Kai, Pang, Lu, Jiang-Lin, Jian-Yu, Kuo, Chia-Han, Shuai, Hong-Han, & Cheng, Wen-Huang (2023). Seeing the Unseen: Wifi-based 2D Human Pose Estimation via an Evolving Attentive Spatial-Frequency Network. Pattern Recognition Letters. (PRL 2023)

## Preprints

**Chen, Yi-Chung**, Jacobson, Philip, Lampo, Tom, Lu, Yiren, Yao, Jin, Inouye, David I., Gao, Jing, Guo, Danhua, & Yaman, Burhan (2026). TraVEL: Trajectory-Guided Video Embedding Learning for Driving-Video Retrieval. (arXiv 2026)

Lu, Yiren, Ye, Xin, Liu, Jiaming, Jacobson, Philip, Yao, Jin, **Chen, Yi-Chung**, Merino, Liam, Kurra, Dhruva Dixith, Cai, Min, Lampo, Tom, Yin, Yu, Guo, Danhua, & Yaman, Burhan (2026). GeoWAM: Visual Geometry World Action Models for Autonomous Driving. (arXiv 2026)

## Workshop Papers

Yang, Hao-Hsiang, Chen, I-Hsiang, Hsieh, Chia-Hsuan, Chang, Hua-En, Chiang, Yuan-Chun, **Chen, Yi-Chung**, Huang, Zhi-Kai, Chen, Wei-Ting, & Kuo, Sy-Yen (2023). Semantic Guidance Learning for High-Resolution Non-Homogeneous Dehazing. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW 2023).

Chang, Hua-En, Hsieh, Chia-Hsuan, Yang, Hao-Hsiang, Chen, I-Hsiang, **Chen, Yi-Chung**, Chiang, Yuan-Chun, Huang, Zhi-Kai, Chen, Wei-Ting, & Kuo, Sy-Yen (2023). TSRFormer: Transformer-Based Two-Stage Refinement for Single-Image Shadow Removal. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW 2023).

## Challenge and Benchmark Reports

Zhang, Yulun, Zhang, Kai, Chen, Zheng, Li, Yawei, Timofte, Radu, et al., **Chen, Yi-Chung** (2023). NTIRE 2023 Challenge on Image Super-Resolution ( $\times 4$ ): Methods and Results. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW 2023).

Ancuti, Codruta O., Ancuti, Cosmin, Vasluianu, Florin-Alexandru, Timofte, Radu, et al., **Chen, Yi-Chung** (2023). NTIRE 2023 HR Non-Homogeneous Dehazing Challenge Report. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW 2023).

Cao, Mingdeng, Mou, Chong, Yu, Fanghua, Wang, Xintao, Zheng, Yinqiang, Timofte, Radu, et al., **Chen, Yi-Chung** (2023). NTIRE 2023 Challenge on 360° Omnidirectional Image and Video Super-Resolution: Datasets, Methods and Results. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW 2023).

Wang, Longguang, Guo, Yulan, Wang, Yingqian, Li, Juncheng, Gu, Shuhang, Timofte, Radu, et al., **Chen, Yi-Chung** (2023). NTIRE 2023 Challenge on Stereo Image Super-Resolution: Methods and Results. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW 2023).

Shutova, Alina, Ershov, Egor, Perevozchikov, Georgy, Ermakov, Ivan, Banić, Nikola, Timofte, Radu, et al., **Chen, Yi-Chung** (2023). NTIRE 2023 Challenge on Night Photography Rendering. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW 2023).

Conde, Marcos V., Zamfir, Eduard, Timofte, Radu, et al., **Chen, Yi-Chung** (2023). Efficient Deep Models for Real-Time 4K Image Super-Resolution: NTIRE 2023 Benchmark and Report. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW 2023).

Li, Yawei, Zhang, Yulun, Timofte, Radu, Van Gool, Luc, et al., **Chen, Yi-Chung** (2023). NTIRE 2023 Challenge on Efficient Super-Resolution: Methods and Results. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW 2023).

## EXPERIENCE

**PhD Software Engineer Intern, Uber AV Labs, Sunnyvale, CA**

*May 2026 - Aug 2026*

- Developed **TraVEL**, a trajectory-guided **GRPO** framework that adapts vision-language embeddings for motion-aware **driving-video retrieval** using ego-trajectory supervision.

**Research Assistant, Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN**

*Aug 2024 - Present*

- Investigated the use of visual autoregressive generative models for classification, demonstrating that **VAR-based classifiers** offer inherent **explainability** and **robustness against catastrophic forgetting** in class-incremental learning.

- Engineer, MediaTek Inc., Hsinchu, Taiwan

Sep 2023 - Sep 2024

- Led the team’s first research project on **diffusion model quantization**, maintaining image generation quality under quantization to enable lightweight deployment on mobile devices; results accepted at **NeurIPS 2024**.
- Research Assistant, NTU, Taipei, Taiwan

Sep 2021 - July 2023

- Studied **contribution evaluation** and **incentive mechanisms** for **federated learning**, published at **NeurIPS 2023**.
- Co-founder, Stylins Ltd., Taipei, Taiwan

Nov 2021 - Feb 2023

- Led product development progress and built a high-resolution, real-time **virtual try-on** service with dynamic clothing size adjustment, enabling interactive user experiences; results recognized at **ICCV 2023**.
- Intern, Synopsys Inc., Hsinchu, Taiwan

July 2021 - Sep 2021

- Built an automated system applying anomaly detection for **root cause analysis** in **IC design verification**.
- Research Assistant, NYCU, Hsinchu, Taiwan

March 2019 - July 2021

- Researched **human pose estimation using WiFi signals**, published in **Pattern Recognition Letters 2023**.  
- Proposed a novel unpaired training framework for **image enhancement**, published in **MMAsia 2019**.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- PC Member / Conference Reviewer

- Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2024–2026  
- International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2026  
- IEEE International Conference on Big Data (BigData) 2025
- Journal Reviewer

- Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR) 2025  
- IEEE Transactions on Knowledge and Data Engineering (TKDE) 2025

HONORS AND AWARDS

- U-start Plan for Innovation and Entrepreneurship

May 2022 - Oct 2022
- International IT Innovative Services Awards - Second Place Award

Nov 2021
- Chunghwa Telecom Co. 5G Innovative Application Award - Honorable Mention

Nov 2021
- ZHAN GUO CE National Innovation and Entrepreneurship Competition - First Place Award

June 2021
- Epoch Foundation Young Entrepreneurs of the Future Plan - First Place Award

July 2021
- Undergraduate research fellowship, Ministry of Science and Technology (MOST)

July 2020 - Feb 2021
- The Yin-Zhi Tong Memorial Scholarship

July 2020

SKILLS

- Programming Skills:

C, C++, Python, Matlab, Javascript, Verilog, System Verilog, Hspice
- Frameworks & Tools :

Pytorch, Keras, Tensorflow, Git, Docker
- Language:

TOEFL iBT 105